

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Earthquake

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

During shaking, Drop, Cover and Hold On. Protect your head and neck beneath a sturdy table if nearby; stay indoors rather than running outside. If near the coast, strong or long shaking may mean tsunami danger: move inland and uphill once shaking stops.

Do now.

- ☐ **Protect yourself now**
01 Drop onto hands and knees and cover your head and neck. With a mobility device, lock wheels and protect your head.
- ☐ **Hold on**
02 Stay under sturdy cover until shaking ends. Keep away from windows and objects that can fall.
- ☐ **If outdoors or driving**
03 Move away from buildings and lines. Pull over safely clear of bridges, wires and trees and remain in the vehicle during shaking.
- ☐ **Check secondary hazards**
04 Expect aftershocks; avoid damaged structures and check for fire, gas leaks and tsunami warnings.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

After shaking, account for people, put on shoes and check from a safe position for fire, gas smell, damaged wiring and instability. Do not reenter a seriously damaged building while waiting for inspection. Expect aftershocks and keep clear of masonry and power lines.

Watch for.

Doorways are not generally the safest shelter. Do not use elevators after damaging shaking.

People & practical needs.

Practice how each person protects their head and body with their actual mobility device or sleeping location. Keep shoes and a light accessible for broken glass afterward

Next decision.

Check injuries and use texts to communicate. Leave a damaged building by stairs when safe and follow official reentry instructions.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Earthquake · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/earthquake/>